

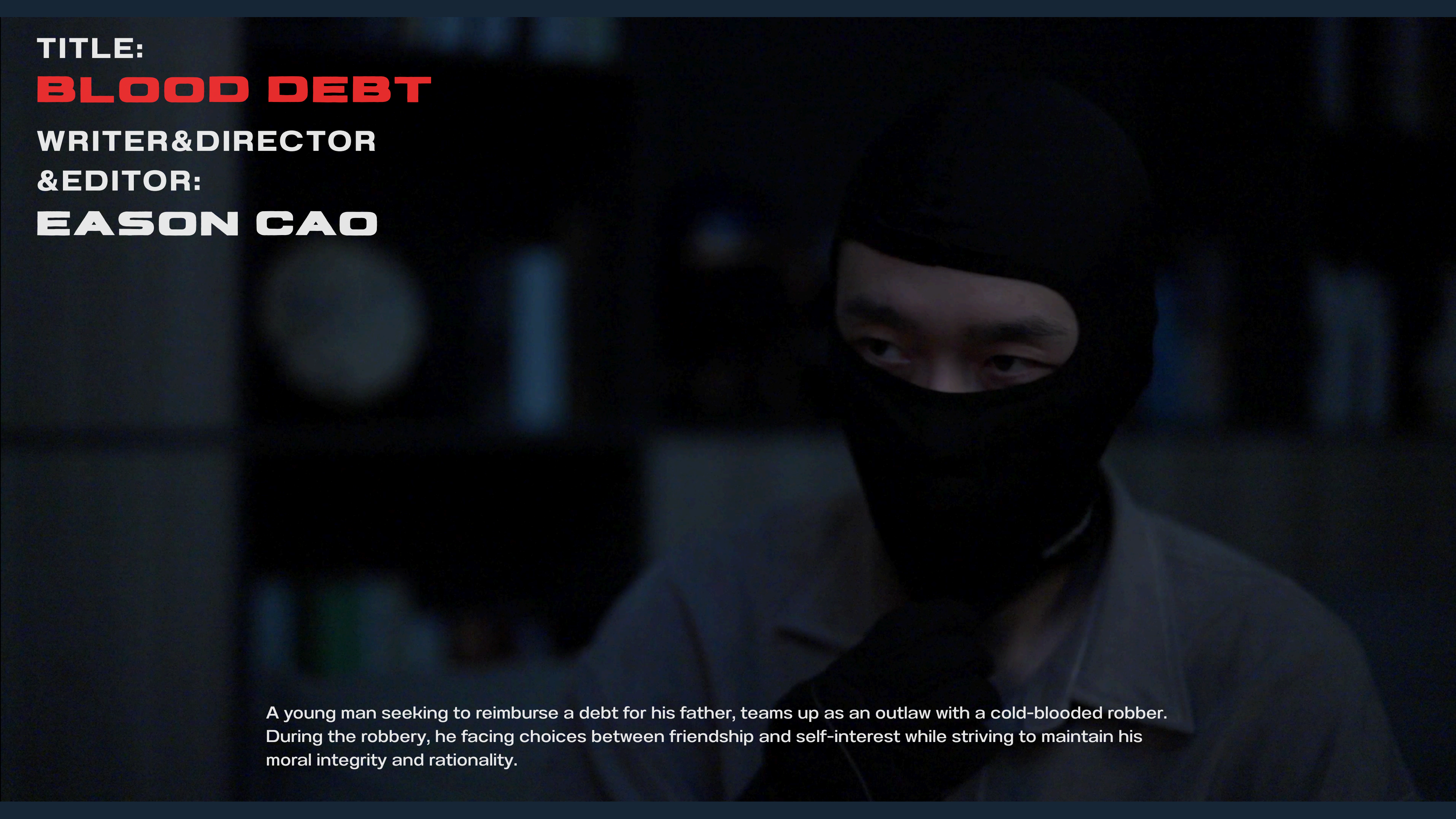


BLOOD DEBT

PORTFOLIO

EASON CAO

Work includes short film and theatre production.

A man wearing a black balaclava, looking slightly to the side. The background is dark and out of focus, suggesting an indoor setting with some light sources.

TITLE:

BLOOD DEBT

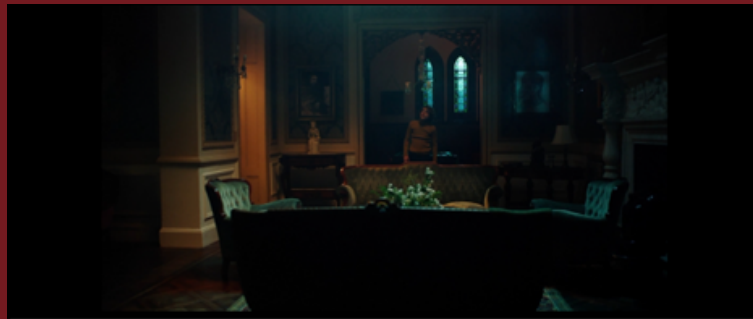
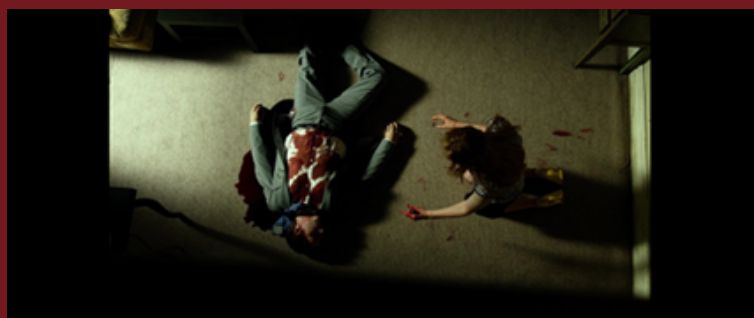
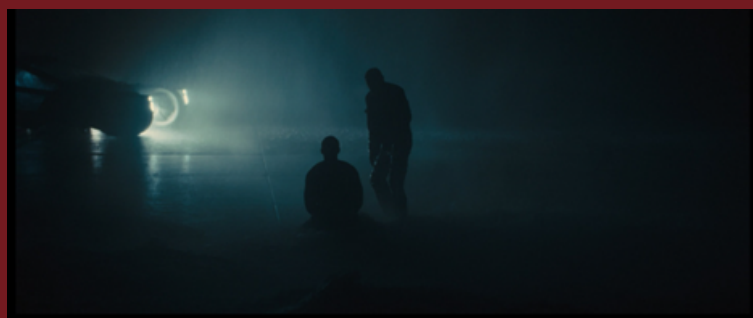
WRITER&DIRECTOR

&EDITOR:

EASON CAO

A young man seeking to reimburse a debt for his father, teams up as an outlaw with a cold-blooded robber. During the robbery, he facing choices between friendship and self-interest while striving to maintain his moral integrity and rationality.

MOODBOARD:



When determine visual style for the short film, I wanted to create a frigid, desolate feeling. So I referenced the color tones from crime movies, lay the foundation of cold and serious feeling.

Considering that most of the plot takes place indoors, I chose some movie clips with indoor crime scenes.

INSPIRATION:



My inspiration comes from the movie “The Death End”. I find it fascinating due to the great act and tensive drama between polices and bandits

This movie explore the topic between Sin and punishment, fear and redemption, loyalty and betrayal. This become the power that how I came out the short film.

BASIC INFORMATION:

DURATION: 4 minutes 59

TITLE: BLOOD DEBT

GENRE: Crime, Suspense

FILMING LOCATION:

Building A, 2nd Floor,
Dream Space,
1650 Laifang Road, Jiuting,
Songjiang, Shanghai.



Zhou Dongxing

ACT by Du Haopeng

AGE: 25

A young man whose family is in debt. His behavior was a bit raw and he looked rather clumsy.



Li Gang

ACT by Li Jiaxuan

AGE: 30

A seasoned criminal with a moral bottom line. He looks very mature and calm, often robbing in a black jacket.



Merchant

ACT by Liu Yang

AGE: 50

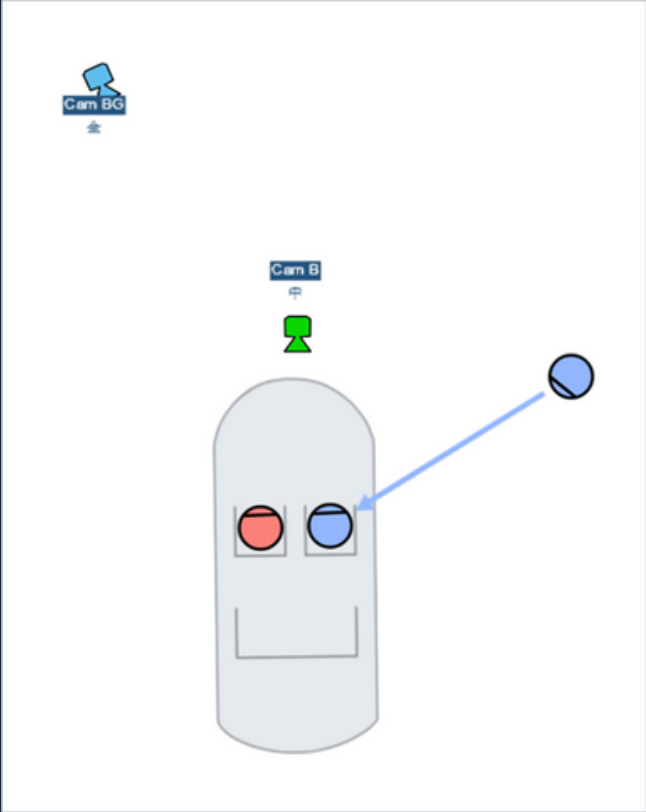
A wealthy and well-disguised merchant appears very gentle and approachable to others.

CASTING:

The audition process was conducted online, where I first reviewed the headshots of the actors who applied to audition for my short film and identified those who best matched the image of my characters. I selected three part what I considered to be the most emotional parts of three characters—the scene when Zhou Dongxing worried about his father, the scene when Li Gang was Angry about Zhou and the scene about merchant was worried about his life—as the parts for the audition.

CAMERA SET UP:

Scene 1
Numbers of cameras: 2
This scene portrays a slow pace moment when Zhou Dongxing and Li Gang were planning about the whole operation, highlighting their partner relationship



SCRIPT:

INT. INSIDE A CAR – NIGHT – 200 METERS FROM A SUBURBAN VILLA

The engine is off. The car window is half-open. Wind mixed with insect chirps seeps into the car.

A villa stands beyond the trees in the outskirts of the city. The car is parked among them.

Dim light from the dashboard reveals **Zhou Dongxing**’s tense profile — a thin young man in a red checkered shirt. His fingers tap unconsciously on the steering wheel.

Li Gang, stronger than Zhou, wearing a black jacket, opens the door, sits in the passenger seat, and pulls a pistol from the glove box.

LI GANG

There’ s a gap in the south wall. Area’ s clear. The target’ s inside. We go in, control the guy — you watch him, I search.

ZHOU DONGXING

Okay.

Li Gang reaches for a shoulder bag in the back seat.

ZHOU DONGXING

Hey, Gang... (swallows) Will this really clear my dad’ s debt?

Li Gang pulls the bag toward him, slips the gun inside.

LI GANG

Do this job right, and it definitely will.

He checks his watch, pulls on a mask.

LI GANG

Time’ s up. Let’ s move.

Zhou puts on his mask and gets out.

The two head toward the villa.

Scene 2
Numbers of cameras: 2
This scene portrays a fast pace and tensive moment when Zhou Dongxing and Li Gang were abducting the merchant, to evoke a sense of tense and chaos.

2. INT. LIVING ROOM – NIGHT

Rain lashes the windows. Lightning flashes.

Zhou opens the door; Li Gang drags in a chubby man in white pajamas and glasses, gripping his collar. Zhou shuts the door and draws the curtains.

Li Gang takes a rope from his bag and quickly ties the **Businessman** to a chair.

LI GANG

Watch him. I’ ll search.

Zhou nods. Li Gang leaves the room with his bag.

3. INT. STUDY – NIGHT

Li Gang kneels by the desk, ear pressed against the cabinet lock.

Click. The safe opens. He stuffs wads of cash into the bag — but suddenly pauses, frowning as if smelling something strange.

4. INT. LIVING ROOM – NIGHT

The businessman watches Zhou casually eat two grapes from the table. He shifts uneasily. Zhou notices.

The businessman’s eyes fix on the fruit plate. He swallows. Zhou hesitates, then picks up two tomatoes and holds them to the man’s mouth, tearing off the tape over it.

The businessman takes a bite.

BUSINESSMAN

You’ re not a bad person at all. You must be in some kind of trouble.

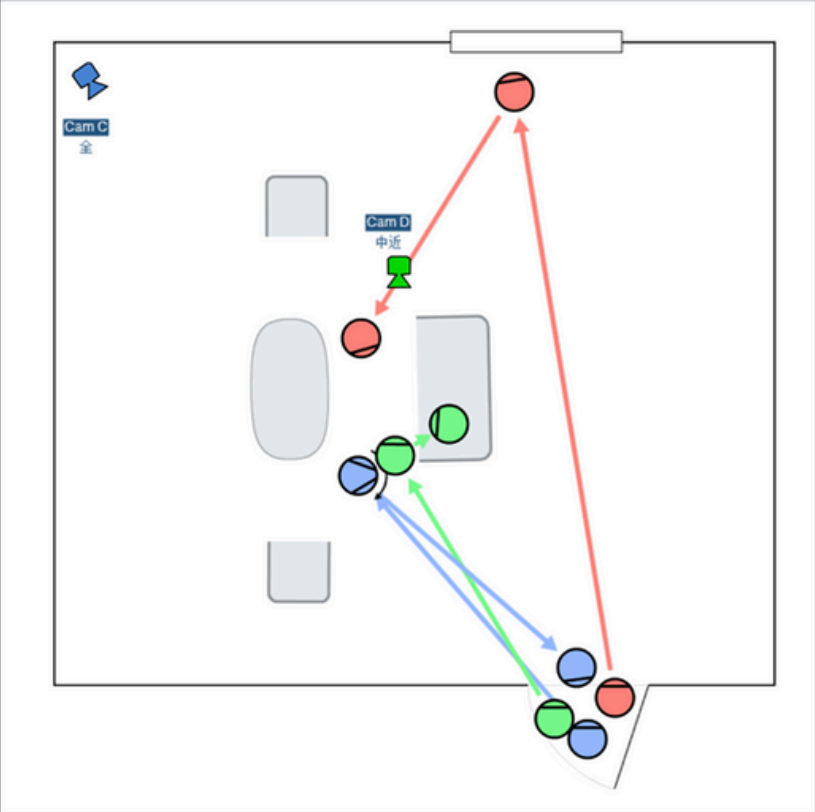
Zhou says nothing.

BUSINESSMAN

Tell me — maybe I can help.

ZHOUD DONGXING

Em... My dad... owes money. If he doesn’ t pay soon, he’ s dead.



ARTS:

Locations:



These are the locations I selected for the film



Art props like Prop gun, blood, bags were bought online.

Art props :



clothes that Li Gang's actor had, and I chose the on in bottom-left side



Zhou Dongxing's actor prepare for the bathroom scene

Art props list:

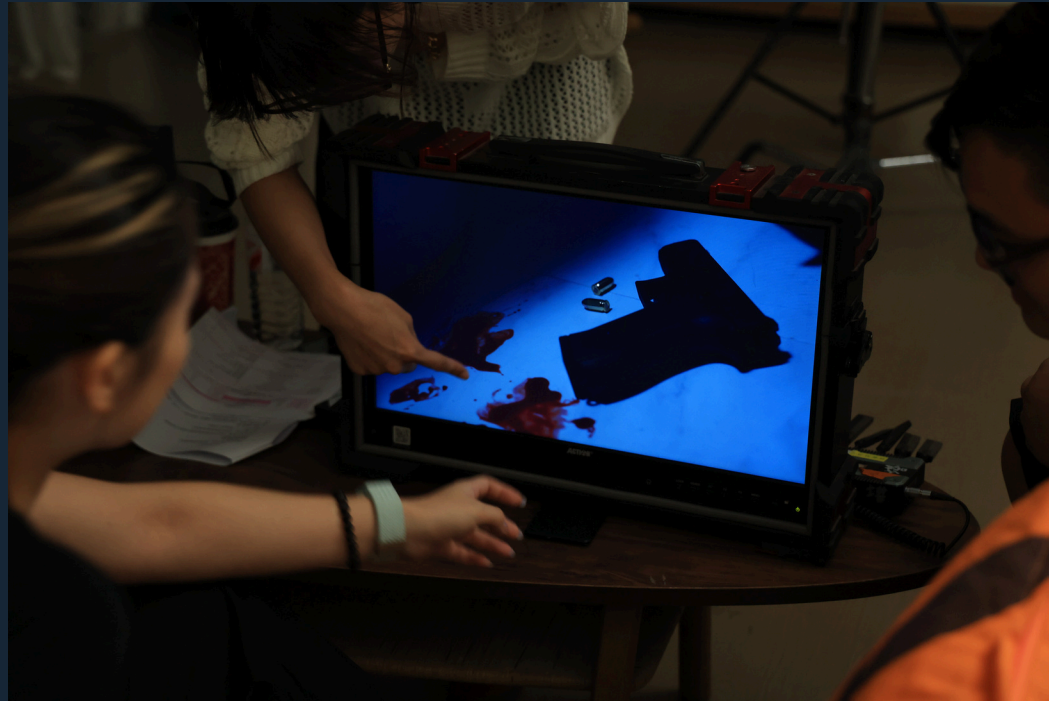


SHOOT DAY:

Locations:

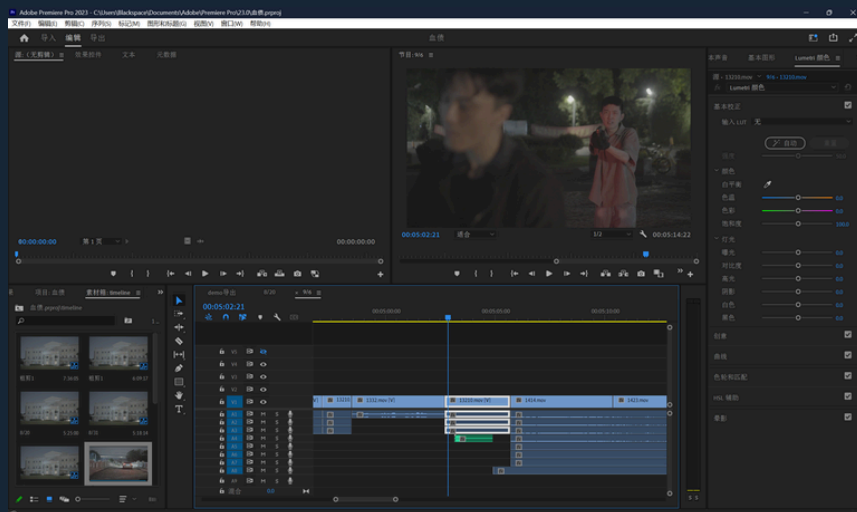


Me steering at the monitor and observing their acts



Me, art team and my teacher was reviewing the scene and adjusting it.

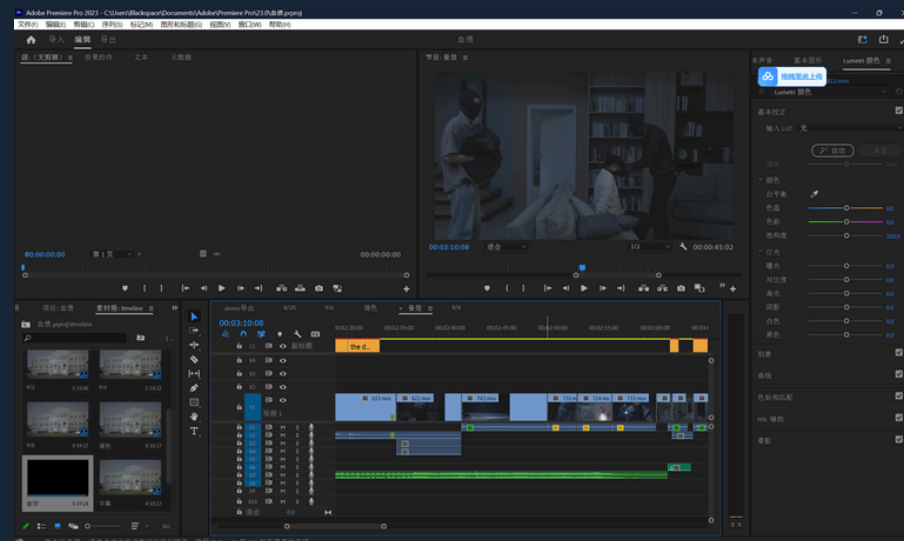
EDITING PROCESS:



1. FOOTAGE SELECTION: I CAREFULLY REVIEWED ALL THE RAW FOOTAGE, CHOOSING THE BEST TAKES FOR EACH SCENE TO ENSURE CONSISTENCY IN PERFORMANCE AND CONTINUITY.

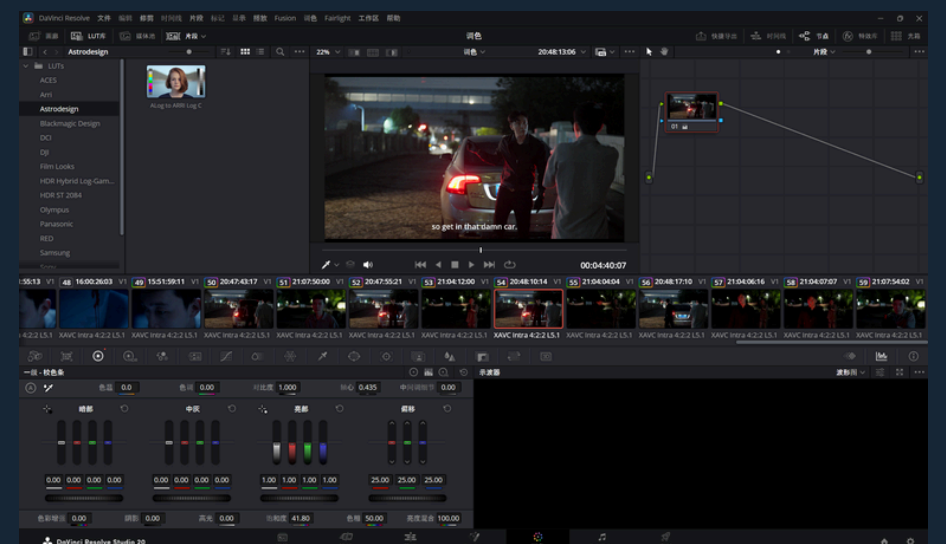
2. TIMELINE ASSEMBLY: THE SELECTED CLIPS WERE ORGANIZED ON THE TIMELINE, WITH INITIAL CUTS MADE TO STRUCTURE THE NARRATIVE FLOW ACCORDING TO THE STORYBOARD.

3. COLOR GRADING: I ADJUSTED THE COLOR TONES TO MATCH THE INTENDED MOOD OF EACH SCENE, ENHANCING THE CINEMATIC QUALITY AND MAINTAINING VISUAL CONSISTENCY THROUGHOUT THE FILM.



4. SOUND DESIGN: BACKGROUND NOISES AND SOUND EFFECTS, WERE ADDED TO CREATE A REALISTIC AND IMMERSIVE ENVIRONMENT

5. TRANSITIONS: SMOOTH TRANSITIONS WERE APPLIED BETWEEN SCENES TO MAINTAIN THE FILM'S RHYTHM AND AVOID ABRUPT CUTS THAT COULD DISRUPT THE VIEWING EXPERIENCE



6.FINAL TOUCHES: I REFINED PACING, ADJUSTED AUDIO LEVELS, AND REVIEWED THE FILM MULTIPLE TIMES TO ENSURE IT CONVEYED THE INTENDED EMOTIONS AND ATMOSPHERE

Schedule sheet:

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